www.tntextbooks.in

EXAMPLE 11.10

Suppose a man stands at a distance from a cliff and claps his hands. He receives an echo from the cliff after 4 second. Calculate the distance between the man and the cliff. Assume the speed of sound to be 343 m s^{-1}.

Solution

The time taken by the sound to come back as echo is $2t = 4 \Rightarrow t = 2$ s

$\therefore$ The distance is $d = vt$ =(343 m s^{-1})(2 s) = 686 m.

Note: Classification of sound waves: Sound waves can be classified in three groups according to their range of frequencies:

(1) ***Infrasonic waves:***
Sound waves having frequencies below 20 Hz are called infrasonic waves. These waves are produced during earthquakes. Human beings cannot hear these frequencies. Snakes can hear these frequencies.

(2) ***Audible waves:***
Sound waves having frequencies between 20 Hz to 20,000 Hz (20kHz) are called audible waves. Human beings can hear these frequencies.

(3) ***Ultrasonic waves:***
Sound waves having frequencies greater than 20 kHz are known as ultrasonic waves. Human beings cannot hear these frequencies. Bats can produce and hear these frequencies.

Note

(1.) Supersonic speed:
An object moving with a speed greater than the speed of sound is said to move with a supersonic speed.

(2.) Mach number:
It is the ratio of the velocity of source to the velocity of sound.

$$\text{Mach number} = \frac{\text{velocity of source}}{\text{velocity of sound}}$$

11.6 PROGRESSIVE WAVES (OR) TRAVELLING WAVES

If a wave that propagates in a medium is continuous then it is known as progressive wave or travelling wave.

11.6.1 Characteristics of progressive waves

1. Particles in the medium vibrate about their mean positions with the same amplitude.
2. The phase of every particle ranges from 0 to 2π.
3. No particle remains at rest permanently. During wave propagation, particles come to the rest position only twice at the extreme points.
4. Transverse progressive waves are characterized by crests and troughs whereas longitudinal progressive waves are characterized by compressions and rarefactions.
5. When the particles pass through the mean position they always move with the same maximum velocity.
6. The displacement, velocity and acceleration of particles separated from each other by $n\lambda$ are the same, where n is an integer, and λ is the wavelength.

11.6.2 Equation of a plane progressive wave

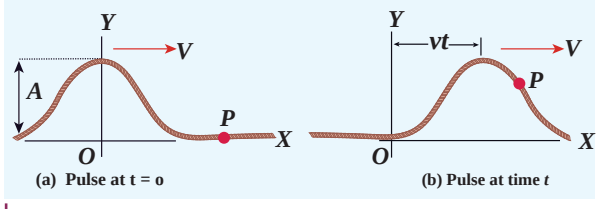


Figure 11.23 Wave pulse moving with velocity v at two instants at $t = 0$ and at time t